

stake. Later when Apple was formally incorporated, Wayne's share was divided among Jobs and Wozniak. For a detailed history of the evolution of Apple, refer to our *Fast Track to Apple*, July 2007.

Wozniak designed a single-board computer and named it the Apple I in 1976. He came up with an advanced logic board based on the MOS Technology 6502 microprocessor, 8 KB of onboard RAM and built-in Video terminals. After struggling to buy the parts for making the Apple I boards, Apple earned a 100% profit on its first sale. By the end of the first year, Apple had a turnover of \$100,000 (Rs 1.4 crore today).

Later, in April 1977, Apple came out with the Apple II, the first personal computer with colour graphics, crammed with 62 chips and ICs. This machine was launched at the West Coast Computer Faire, the Microcomputer Trade Show at San Francisco, and the response from the crowd was fabulous. The Apple II was a successful machine on which Apple cashed enough to establish itself as a primary player in the computer business.

As the company began to expand, more challenges and expectations were to be met. By 1980, Apple had become a large multinational corporation and the same year launched the Apple III. But—due to mismanagement—sales of the Apple III dipped.

But eventually, when VisiCalc, the first ever computer spreadsheet, was developed, sales doubled. (After the 1980s, the Lisa and Macintosh hit the market; they featured a GUI and mouse.)

July: Intel Gets Competition

After Federico Faggin left Intel, he started Zilog with Ralph Ungermann, and it became a direct competitor to Intel in 1976. The Zilog Z80 was an 8-bit microprocessor design and was sold in July 1976. It was object-code compatible with the Intel 8080 CPU, which means machine language written could be understood by that CPU. It also offered many improvements over the 8080, and therefore became the most popular of the 8-bit CPUs.